Ardú · Project summary · October 2026

Prepared by the founder, Ahmed Abuhassan · figures at Gaza prices in October 2026, confirmed by written quotes before any spending · ardugaza.org · info@ardugaza.org

What Ardú is

Ardú is Irish for a lifting, a raising up. It is a youth initiative built in Gaza, for Gaza. A family home in central Gaza City was brought down in the war. Beneath it stands a hall of about 500 square metres, on columns that held. Ardú clears the rubble, and what comes out of it, steel and stone, goes back into preparing the space. Nothing in the opening needs cement, so the opening does not wait on the crossings. Before anyone sits under it, an engineer signs off the structure.

Young people in Gaza have the talent. What they do not have is a place to sit, power that lasts a working day, a connection that holds, and somebody who has walked the road before them. Ardú puts those four things in one room and measures itself by one result: young people earning, working and competing from where they are. It is not relief. It is a lifting.

At a glance

WHAT	FIGURE
Seats at opening	100 per shift, two four-hour shifts a day, 200 young adults a day
End of phase one	200 seats per shift, 400 a day, 20 kilowatts
Full build, if the engineer confirms a second floor	500 seats per shift, up to 1,000 a day
Who gets in	Adults 18 and over, on criteria published before the first intake; women and men in separate sections with identical hours and services
Courses	Four tracks with partner organisations in repeating cycles: English, freelancing and remote work, career readiness, digital skills; certificates from the partner
Paid desks	Freelancers, 8 to 4, $50 a month
The street	Surplus power and eight-hour blocks of internet at under half the market price, outside the hall's hours
Earned income target	Half of launch-level running costs from the place itself within the first year, actual figure published monthly
Positions in Gaza	8, on written contracts, on a four-level salary ladder tied to funding
Status	Unregistered initiative; formal registration planned; no charitable registration or tax deductibility claimed

Five stages

#	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	ESTIMATE
1	Clear the rubble	The home's rubble is removed and the hall beneath it is freed. Salvaged steel and stone go into preparing the space.	about $15,000
2	Light, water, line	Wiring and lighting, toilets and water, the fibre line and the network.	about $30,000
3	Seats and sun	Ten seats at a time: furniture, a shared laptop, one kilowatt of solar with storage. The doors open with the first blocks and reach 100 seats.	about $12,000 per ten seats
4	Keep the doors open	Eight people on written contracts, internet, consumables, the first course cycles, at launch salaries.	$8,000 a month; $48,000 for six months
5	Grow on the numbers	To 200 seats and 20 kilowatts; then a second floor towards 500 seats when the engineer confirms it; then online.	block by block; second floor $70,000–$100,000

Doors open at 100 seats: about $165,000. With six months of running: about $213,000.

A kilowatt that works twice

Every kilowatt Ardú installs powers ten seats by day. Outside the hall's hours and on days off, its surplus goes to the houses on the street at half the market price, and the fibre line does the same with hours of internet. Together with desk fees, that income goes to the running costs, every shekel recorded and published. At today's prices a kilowatt repays its own cost in six to eight months, which is why Ardú buys them as fast as they are funded. The rules: surplus only; always below the market price; a published tariff and a numbered receipt for every shekel; everything to the running costs.

The full plan

Intro This page carries the detail behind the five stages: the figures and how they were built, what each stage buys, how spending is verified, how the place earns part of its own keep, and what is still open. Every number is an estimate at Gaza prices in October 2026, confirmed by written quotes before any money is spent. Where a figure depends on a condition, the condition is stated next to it.

1 · The place

A hall of about 500 square metres with a six-metre ceiling under a family home in central Gaza City. The home was brought down in the war; the hall's columns held, its roof and walls did not. Stage one removes the rubble above and around it, sorts what can be reused, and prepares the floor. The opening uses sheeting, salvaged steel and wood, and no cement, so it does not depend on construction materials crossing into Gaza. An engineer's structural report is obtained before the hall carries any load. The hall is the family's property, used by Ardú under a written agreement at a symbolic rent that is entered in the accounts. The exact location is shared with funders and partners on request and is not published.

2 · Stages, amounts and verification

STAGE	WHAT IT BUYS	ESTIMATE	HOW YOU VERIFY IT
1 · Clear the rubble	Clearance, sorting of salvage, preparation of the floor and the space.	about $15,000	Before-and-after photographs; labour and haulage receipts.
2 · Light, water, line	Wiring and lighting ($10–12k), toilets and water ($10–12k), fibre installation ($5–8k), internal network and UPS ($3–4k).	about $30,000	Invoices; the fibre contract; photographs.
3 · Seats and sun	Per block of ten seats: furniture, one shared laptop, one kilowatt of solar with storage. The first blocks carry the hybrid inverter and storage sized for 20 kW so later blocks plug in without rework.	about $12,000 per block; 100 seats about $120,000	Quotes; installation photographs; the inverter's own monitoring data.
4 · Keep the doors open	Eight positions on written contracts, internet, consumables, communications, the first course cycles.	$8,000 a month at launch salaries; $48,000 for six months	Contracts; the monthly payroll sheet; attendance; the course calendar.
5 · Grow on the numbers	Blocks 11 to 20 (to 200 seats and 20 kW); a steel second floor and cement finishing when materials allow, towards 500 seats, conditional on the engineer's confirmation.	about $120,000; second floor $70,000–$100,000	Structural report; photographs.

Doors open at 100 seats: about $165,000. With six months of running: about $213,000. Stage five is additional and conditional.

3 · Capacity and the working day

Two four-hour shifts for the supported group, 8 to 12 and 12 to 4, 100 seats per shift, 50 women and 50 men in separate sections with identical hours and services, which is 200 young adults a day at opening and 400 a day at 200 seats. Freelancers rent full-day desks, 8 to 4, at $50 a month, by capacity, added block by block like every other seat. Intake is adults 18 and over, on criteria published before the first intake that weigh ability and financial situation together. In seat-days: about 57,600 a year at opening, about 115,000 at 200 seats, about 288,000 at the full build.

4 · Energy: the design and the arithmetic

In October 2026 a kilowatt of installed solar with storage costs about $10,000 in Gaza City, and a kilowatt-hour from the generator lines costs $10 to $12. One kilowatt yields about 135 kWh a month, worth $1,350 to $1,600 at line prices, so a kilowatt repays itself in six to eight months. The line cannot be the baseline: 100 seats draw about 50 to 55 kWh a day, which is more than $13,000 a month from the lines, more than the whole payroll at launch. The design is a hybrid inverter and storage with headroom to 20 kW, panels added one kilowatt per block, both shifts inside daylight so storage only covers the gaps, and the generator line kept for the odd hour. The policy is to buy kilowatts as fast as they are funded while the payback stays under two years, to re-quote before every purchase, and to treat falling prices as cheaper growth. Every figure here is at today's prices.

5 · Earned income

Three lines. Desks: $50 a month per freelancer desk. Surplus power: a 10 kW system produces about 1,350 kWh a month; the hall uses most of it on working days, and days off and the hours before and after the shifts leave about 400 to 500 kWh a month, which at half the market price is $2,000 to $3,000 a month. Internet hours: the fibre line costs about $500 a month; outside the hall's hours its capacity is sold to the street in eight-hour blocks at under half the market price, and the line pays for itself first. The target is half of launch-level running costs covered by these three lines within the first year, with the actual figure published every month. Four rules govern all three: surplus only; always below the market price; a published tariff and a numbered receipt for every shekel; everything into the running costs.

6 · Running costs and the team

Eight positions on written contracts in Gaza: a site manager, a programme coordinator, a technical officer, two reception staff (one for each section), maintenance and night presence, part-time accounts, and the founder as chief executive. Salaries sit on a four-level ladder tied to funding. Full rates are $4,000 for the manager, $3,000 for the coordinator, $2,000 for the technical officer, $1,600 each for reception, maintenance and accounts, and $5,000 for the chief executive, a payroll of $20,000 a month at level four. Everyone starts at a quarter of the full rate and the whole team steps up together: payroll $5,000, $10,000, $15,000, $20,000. Fixed costs are about $3,000 a month (internet, consumables, communications, maintenance, and the generator line for the odd hour), so running costs go from $8,000 to $23,000 a month across the ladder. Trainers come on per-course contracts with partner organisations and sit outside payroll. Spending, recording and approval sit with different people.

7 · Accountability

Contributions are held in the UK by an academic trustee under a signed agreement, on the model already used to fund the founder's own studies, and released stage by stage to a bank account used only for Ardú. Every expense has a numbered ledger entry, a receipt, and where it applies a contract and a photograph of what was bought or built. The person who spends is not the person who keeps the books. Accounts are reconciled monthly and supporters receive an itemised monthly statement. Funders and partners may request the full ledger, with the personal data of staff and students protected.

8 · Status and what is still open

As of October 2026 Ardú is an unregistered initiative with a plan, a site, a brand and a public presence; formal registration is planned and no charitable registration or tax deductibility is claimed. Open before the first spend: the engineer's structural report, two written quotes for each stage, the family use agreement, the first tariff for desks, power and internet hours, and the published intake criteria. No partner is named before its agreement is signed.

9 · The four-year picture

Capital: about $165,000 to open at 100 seats, about $120,000 to reach 200 seats and 20 kW, and $70,000 to $100,000 for the second floor if it is confirmed, which is $355,000 to $385,000 in all. Running: six months at level one ($48,000), six months at level two ($78,000), a second year at level three ($216,000) and two years at level four ($552,000), which is $894,000. Together about $1.25 to $1.28 million over four years before earned income. The earned-income target of half the running costs from the place itself would take a large part of that off the donors, and the actual figures are published as they happen rather than promised in advance.

10 · How to fund it and how to reach us

The units: the rubble, $15,000. Light, water and line, $30,000. Ten seats and their kilowatt, $12,000. A kilowatt on its own, $10,000. A month of running, $8,000. Contributions go through the trustee route above; the giving link opens on the date announced on ardugaza.org, and larger contributions are arranged in a direct conversation. info@ardugaza.org · Ardú on LinkedIn · the founder on LinkedIn.